

2 Information security



2.1 Passwords

2.1.1 Access Denied

In popular media, “cracking” passwords is often oversimplified. The hacker sits on the computer, mutters a few words about opening sockets and ports, multiple screens light up green over a black backdrop. The hacker somehow manages to “crack” the password by bashing keys on his keyboard – sometimes even multiple keyboards – in what seems to be a random manner while under the influence of fellatio. What impression is one to make of this?

In reality the scene is much different. You can make do with one keyboard and monitor – you won’t be typing all the passwords yourself anyway – and can probably make do without the stimulation.

In reality, hacking passwords is something which requires a lot of research and time. If you are doing some social engineering, it may require considerable work on your part. Finally, it is your computer which does a bulk of the processing work. Chances are you will be twiddling your fingers or catching up to your book reading while your computer is hard at work.

Fact is it isn’t very difficult to make an “impossible” to crack password. Well, theoretically, any password can be cracked given enough time, but when you put in reasonable constraints, you will find that beyond a point, nothing can be done. When we talk to reasonable limits, that would